

**LISTENING
#18****Teacher's Guide****SCRIPT: CAR ACCIDENT**

Man: Honey. Do you know what time Katie will be home?

Woman: Uh, she should be here any minute. She took the car to pick up something from the store.

Man: Okay, I was just a little worried that . . . Man, what was that? Oh, no. The car! She drove over the mailbox and hit a tree in the front yard. Ah, the car!

Woman: Well, just don't stand there blabbing all day. Let's go out and see if Katie's okay.

Man: Ah, my car.

Woman: Honey, are you okay?

Daughter: Oh, mom. I'm so sorry. I can't believe this is happening.

Man: Oh, my car!

Woman: Forget your car!

Man: Driving with the cell phone. I know.

Daughter: It wasn't that at all. Don't jump to conclusions.

Man: Oh, yeah.

Daughter: Dad . . . um, mom. It's not like that at all. I mean, as I was pulling into the driveway, something rolled from under the seat and got stuck under the brake pedal . . . the gas pedal . . . I, I don't know, and I couldn't stop the car. And then I accidentally hit the gas when I wanted to brake, and I hit the mailbox.

Woman: Uh, I think I know what the problem was. Honey, did you put those golf balls away like I told you? [Huh?] The ones YOU put under the driver's seat . . . the ones I told you would get in the way.

Man: Man, I thought I got those.

Daughter: Plus, Mom, the windshield wipers on the car didn't work, so I couldn't see very well in the rain.

Woman: Didn't you get those fixed?

Man: Uh, I've been meaning to get those repaired.

Daughter: And mom. I was going to use the car this weekend to go camping with my friends, but now my plans are ruined. My friends are going to hate me. What am I going to do?

Woman: Hon, yeah, what IS your daughter going to do? It appears it's mainly your fault for the accident and that she's in such a jam.

Man: My fault? Hey, why don't you just invite your friends over for pizza? I'll buy.

Daughter: Mom, we've been planning this weekend for months. I need a car.

Woman: Hon.

Man: What? I mean, man, what a predicament! That's tough.

Woman: I think what your dad is trying to say is that you can take his new Jeep.

Daughter: Yeah, awesome.

Man: What?

Daughter: Yes!

Man: Wait, not my new Jeep. I don't even have 500 miles on it.

Daughter: Four-wheeling through the mud, over big rocks and in deep ruts in the road . . . if there is a road.

Man: Ah.

Woman: You love your daughter, don't you?

Man: Ask me after she returns from the trip.

Daughter: Ah, Dad. I'm gonna [going to] call my friends to let them know the good news. Thanks, Dad, I knew I could count on you.

Man: Yeah, but make sure wrecking the car doesn't become a routine activity.

Daughter: Dad!

Answer Key

Comprehension Activity

1. She drove over the **mailbox**.
2. He **panicked** and kept saying, "Oh, my car!"
3. She felt **sorry and upset**.
4. He assumed she was **using her cell phone while driving**.
5. Something **rolled from under the seat and got stuck under the pedals**, causing her to accidentally hit the gas.

6. Golf balls

7. Because the **windshield wipers didn't work**, so she had trouble seeing in the rain.
8. Her **plans to go camping with friends were ruined** because she couldn't use the car.
9. She suggested **asking the father to provide a car**.
10. The daughter could use the father's **new Jeep** for the trip.

Reading Comprehension Activity

1. Young drivers are **twice as likely to crash** as the average driver.
2. The average cost of an accident involving a 17- or 18-year-old is **£3,500**, roughly **twice the overall average of £1,741**.
3. The program that helps young people learn to drive safely is the **Young Driver program**, sponsored by Admiral.

Idioms

"Jump to conclusions" = to make a decision without knowing all the facts

"Don't jump to conclusions about the accident — we need to ask what really happened first."

"In a jam" = in trouble or a difficult situation

"Katie's parents realized she was in a jam after the car accident."

"Predicament" = a difficult or tricky situation

"Finding a car for the camping trip put the family in a real predicament."